



Bank Alfalah

ALFA LEAD **ASSESSMENT** **CENTER**

**ASSESSOR COMPETENCY
RUBRIC**



ASSESSOR COMPETENCY RUBRIC

Purpose of This Rubric

This document is the primary scoring instrument for all assessors involved in the ALFA Lead Management Trainee Assessment Center. Each candidate is assessed individually, even within group activities. Scores must reflect observed behaviour during the activity — not prior impressions or perceived potential.

Assessment Rounds Covered:

Round 1 — Case Study: Problem Solving Ability | Business Acumen | Teamwork | Ownership

Round 2 — The Bank Alfalah Experience Center: Innovation & Creativity | Resilience & Agility | Teamwork | Problem Solving Ability | Commitment to Process Improvement | Ownership | Business Acumen | Stakeholder Management

Round 3 — Solve That Conflict: Conduct & Integrity | Emotional Intelligence | Interpersonal Skills | Ownership | Teamwork | Inclusivity | Stakeholder Management | Problem Solving Ability

✗ Common Assessor Biases to Avoid

1. Halo Effect: Do not let one strong competency inflate scores across the board.
2. Leniency/Severity Bias: Anchor scores to the behavioural descriptors, not to how you feel about the candidate.
3. Similar-to-Me Bias: Candidates with different communication styles may still score a 4.
4. First Impression Bias: Scores must reflect behaviour throughout the round, not just early moments.
5. Central Tendency: Use the full 1–4 scale. A '2' and a '4' are both valid and important distinctions.

✓ Best Practice Reminders

1. Take notes in real time — do not rely on memory at the end of the session.
2. Record specific behavioural evidence, not general impressions (e.g. 'Said X when Y happened', not 'seemed confident').
3. Assess each candidate independently, even within group activities.
4. Do not discuss scores with other assessors until the calibration session.
5. If you are uncertain between two scores, select the lower score and note it for discussion.

Round 1: Case Study

Group discussion, analysis and presentation of business case

Assessor Instructions: Observe the candidate throughout this round. Record a score of 1–4 for each competency and note specific behavioural evidence. Scores must be based on observed behaviour, not perceived potential.

Competency	1 – Significantly Below	2 – Partially Meets	3 – Meets Expectations	4 – Exceeds Expectations
Problem Solving Ability	Jumps to conclusions without looking at the information available. Cannot break down the problem or spot what's missing. Arguments are based on opinions, not analysis.	Tries to organize the problem but the analysis is incomplete or poorly focused. Uses some data but misses important patterns or connections.	Breaks the problem into clear parts. Spots patterns and cause-effect relationships in the data. Can clearly explain what information is needed and why.	Tackles the problem with both structure and creativity. Finds insights others miss. Challenges the group's assumptions in a constructive way and arrives at strong, well-supported solutions.
Business Acumen	Cannot explain the business goal of the task. Arguments have no commercial logic. Cannot engage with trade-offs between cost, risk, and return even when prompted.	Shows some awareness of business context but stays on the surface. Struggles to take a clear position or persuade others with solid reasoning.	Weights pros and cons carefully before taking a clear, well-reasoned position. Actively adds commercially relevant ideas that move the group forward.	Brings sharp commercial thinking that changes how the group sees the problem. Persuades others with evidence-based arguments. Shows a strong grasp of risk, return, and market realities.
Teamwork	Works alone; doesn't help teammates. Talks over others without listening. Takes sole credit or blames others when things go wrong. Creates friction that slows the group.	Sometimes collaborates but tends to work individually. Joins in when asked but rarely volunteers help. Contribution to the group's energy is patchy or passive.	Actively supports teammates; helps unblock others without being asked. Builds a cooperative atmosphere and adds positively to group dynamics. Shares credit openly.	Lifts the entire team's performance. Proactively shifts workload, fills gaps, and builds collective ownership. The group visibly performs better because of this person.
Ownership	Avoids responsibility — deflects blame and waits for others to step up. Shows little care for quality or the group's success. Checks out when the task gets hard.	Takes responsibility when directly given a task but doesn't step up on their own. Quality is acceptable but not driven by personal standards.	Takes full responsibility for tasks and outcomes. Spots and fixes issues without waiting for direction. Shows pride in the group's output.	Goes beyond their assigned role. Raises the bar for the whole group by holding themselves and others to high standards. Doesn't let problems sit — acts decisively.

Round 2: The Bank Alfalah Experience Center

Physical build + Feasibility and Operational Model

Assessor Instructions: Observe the candidate throughout this round. Record a score of 1–4 for each competency and note specific behavioural evidence. Scores must be based on observed behaviour, not perceived potential.

Competency	1 – Significantly Below	2 – Partially Meets	3 – Meets Expectations	4 – Exceeds Expectations
Innovation & Creativity	Sticks entirely to obvious, safe ideas. Shows no original thinking. Either avoids any risk altogether (plays it completely safe) or takes reckless, unthought-out risks that hurt the output. Does not contribute anything new or different.	Suggests some ideas but they are mostly conventional. Willing to consider new approaches but doesn't commit to them. May propose a bold idea but can't explain the reasoning or trade-offs behind it.	Brings original ideas that improve the group's design. Willing to take calculated risks — can explain what they're betting on and what could go wrong. Pushes the group beyond the obvious without being reckless. Balances creativity with practicality.	Generates ideas that fundamentally change how the group approaches the challenge. Convinces the team to take a bold direction they wouldn't have considered alone, backed by a clear risk-benefit argument. Shows that being creative and being rigorous are not opposites. Others are energized by their thinking.
Resilience & Agility	Falls apart when things change. Becomes visibly frustrated, disengaged, or defensive when a constraint is introduced. Cannot adjust the plan or recover momentum. Gives up or stalls the group.	Handles small changes but struggles with bigger disruptions. Recovers slowly. May adjust one part of the plan but doesn't rethink the bigger picture. Energy drops noticeably under pressure.	Stays composed when constraints hit. Adjusts the plan quickly and practically. Maintains energy and focus through setbacks. Helps the group regroup and move forward without wasting time.	Thrives under pressure. Treats disruptions as opportunities, not obstacles. Quickly reframes the situation for the group, proposes a revised approach, and keeps everyone moving. The group's confidence visibly increases because of this person's steadiness.
Teamwork	Works alone; doesn't help teammates. Talks over others without listening. Takes sole credit or blames others when things go wrong. Creates friction that slows the group.	Sometimes collaborates but tends to work individually. Joins in when asked but rarely volunteers help. Contribution to the group's energy is patchy or passive.	Actively supports teammates; helps unblock others without being asked. Builds a cooperative atmosphere and adds positively to group dynamics. Shares credit openly.	Lifts the entire team's performance. Proactively shifts workload, fills gaps, and builds collective ownership. The group visibly performs better because of this person.
Problem Solving Ability	Jumps to conclusions without looking at the information available. Cannot break down the problem or spot what's missing. Arguments are based on opinions, not analysis.	Tries to organize the problem but the analysis is incomplete or poorly focused. Uses some data but misses important patterns or connections.	Breaks the problem into clear parts. Spots patterns and cause-effect relationships in the data. Can clearly explain what information is needed and why.	Tackles the problem with both structure and creativity. Finds insights others miss. Challenges the group's assumptions in a constructive way and arrives at strong, well-supported solutions.

Competency	1 – Significantly Below	2 – Partially Meets	3 – Meets Expectations	4 – Exceeds Expectations
Commitment to Process Improvement	Accepts mediocre output without question. Loses focus easily and doesn't push the group to do better. Takes no responsibility for improving how things are done ('I did my part').	Stays engaged but mostly follows the current approach without questioning it. Only suggests improvements when directly asked.	Challenges the group's approach in a constructive way. Stays committed through setbacks. Shows eagerness to keep refining and improving the output.	Acts as the group's internal quality checker — constantly looking for ways to do things better and energizing others to join in. Drives a culture of iteration and continuous improvement.
Ownership	Avoids responsibility — deflects blame and waits for others to step up. Shows little care for quality or the group's success. Checks out when the task gets hard.	Takes responsibility when directly given a task but doesn't step up on their own. Quality is acceptable but not driven by personal standards.	Takes full responsibility for tasks and outcomes. Spots and fixes issues without waiting for direction. Shows pride in the group's output.	Goes beyond their assigned role. Raises the bar for the whole group by holding themselves and others to high standards. Doesn't let problems sit — acts decisively.
Business Acumen	Cannot explain the business goal of the task. Arguments have no commercial logic. Cannot engage with trade-offs between cost, risk, and return even when prompted.	Shows some awareness of business context but stays on the surface. Struggles to take a clear position or persuade others with solid reasoning.	Weights pros and cons carefully before taking a clear, well-reasoned position. Actively adds commercially relevant ideas that move the group forward.	Brings sharp commercial thinking that changes how the group sees the problem. Persuades others with evidence-based arguments. Shows a strong grasp of risk, return, and market realities.
Stakeholder Management	Focused only on their own agenda; ignores the impact on others. Fails to reassure the group when things are uncertain. Undermines group confidence.	Recognizes that different people have different interests but struggles to balance them. Supports the group when asked, but doesn't step in proactively.	Works towards a shared goal with clear awareness of different needs. Proactively supports and reassures the group, especially during tough moments.	Aligns everyone around a shared direction with skill and credibility. Anticipates concerns before they surface and addresses them convincingly. Visibly strengthens group trust and cohesion.

Round 3: Solve That Conflict

Role-based conflict resolution scenario

Assessor Instructions: Observe the candidate throughout this round. Record a score of 1–4 for each competency and note specific behavioural evidence. Scores must be based on observed behaviour, not perceived potential.

Competency	1 – Significantly Below	2 – Partially Meets	3 – Meets Expectations	4 – Exceeds Expectations
Conduct & Integrity	Distorts facts, hides key information, or takes credit for others' ideas to gain personal advantage. Shows visible favouritism or makes decisions based on personal preference, not evidence. Ignores concerns about fairness. Compromises integrity for personal gain.	Generally honest but sometimes spins information or leaves out inconvenient facts. May be reluctant to admit mistakes. Tries to be fair but occasionally lets personal biases influence decisions. Doesn't always apply the same standards to everyone.	Communicates truthfully, even when it's uncomfortable. Admits mistakes openly. Makes decisions based on facts, not favourites. Treats everyone with equal respect and can explain why their conclusions are objective and consistent.	Goes out of their way to surface uncomfortable truths, including their own errors. Actively calls out hidden biases in the group's thinking. Builds trust rapidly through radical honesty. Others visibly treat them as the group's honest broker. Creates a standard of fairness that the group aligns around.
Emotional Intelligence	Reacts impulsively under pressure — raises voice, shuts down, or becomes aggressive. Dismisses others' feelings. Gets defensive when challenged or given feedback.	Manages emotions adequately in calm moments but loses composure under pressure or conflict. Empathy is inconsistent; sometimes misreads how others are feeling.	Stays calm and composed under pressure. Reads the emotional temperature of the group and responds appropriately. Takes feedback constructively without becoming defensive.	Exceptional emotional control, even in high-pressure or confrontational moments. Acts as a stabilizing force for the group. Turns tense moments into constructive conversations.
Interpersonal Skills	Uses condescending or dismissive language. Constantly interrupts. Makes no effort to connect with others; communication feels hostile or purely transactional.	Communicates adequately but struggles to adjust their style for different people. May occasionally interrupt or use language that pushes others away. Any rapport is surface-level.	Builds genuine rapport with different individuals. Uses diplomacy and tact. Listens carefully and adjusts how they communicate based on the situation and the audience.	Naturally connects with everyone in the room. Reads social dynamics instantly and adjusts. Others feel genuinely heard and valued. Acts as a social anchor for the group.
Ownership	Avoids responsibility — deflects blame and waits for others to step up. Shows little care for quality or the group's success. Checks out when the task gets hard.	Takes responsibility when directly given a task but doesn't step up on their own. Quality is acceptable but not driven by personal standards.	Takes full responsibility for tasks and outcomes. Spots and fixes issues without waiting for direction. Shows pride in the group's output.	Goes beyond their assigned role. Raises the bar for the whole group by holding themselves and others to high standards. Doesn't let problems sit — acts decisively.

Competency	1 – Significantly Below	2 – Partially Meets	3 – Meets Expectations	4 – Exceeds Expectations
Teamwork	Works alone; doesn't help teammates. Talks over others without listening. Takes sole credit or blames others when things go wrong. Creates friction that slows the group.	Sometimes collaborates but tends to work individually. Joins in when asked but rarely volunteers help. Contribution to the group's energy is patchy or passive.	Actively supports teammates; helps unblock others without being asked. Builds a cooperative atmosphere and adds positively to group dynamics. Shares credit openly.	Lifts the entire team's performance. Proactively shifts workload, fills gaps, and builds collective ownership. The group visibly performs better because of this person.
Inclusivity	Dismisses or ignores contributions from certain people. Monopolizes the discussion. Creates an environment where others feel excluded or unsafe to speak.	Doesn't actively exclude anyone but also makes no effort to bring in quieter voices. Mostly engages with the more confident peers; misses chances to involve the full group.	Shows empathy and actively listens. Creates space for different perspectives. Makes sure everyone has a real chance to contribute meaningfully.	Deliberately and skillfully draws out quieter members. Synthesizes diverse views into a richer group output. Champions psychological safety — others are visibly more confident because of this person.
Stakeholder Management	Focused only on their own agenda; ignores the impact on others. Fails to reassure the group when things are uncertain. Undermines group confidence.	Recognizes that different people have different interests but struggles to balance them. Supports the group when asked, but doesn't step in proactively.	Works towards a shared goal with clear awareness of different needs. Proactively supports and reassures the group, especially during tough moments.	Aligns everyone around a shared direction with skill and credibility. Anticipates concerns before they surface and addresses them convincingly. Visibly strengthens group trust and cohesion.
Problem Solving Ability	Jumps to conclusions without looking at the information available. Cannot break down the problem or spot what's missing. Arguments are based on opinions, not analysis.	Tries to organize the problem but the analysis is incomplete or poorly focused. Uses some data but misses important patterns or connections.	Breaks the problem into clear parts. Spots patterns and cause-effect relationships in the data. Can clearly explain what information is needed and why.	Tackles the problem with both structure and creativity. Finds insights others miss. Challenges the group's assumptions in a constructive way and arrives at strong, well-supported solutions.